

MSI Sky Talk

A Wire-Free Existence

Bluetooth, a feature earlier available only in high-end mobile phones and PDAs, has now made its way to mid-range models as well. More users want Bluetooth-enabled phones to transfer data and images, synchronise contacts and install applications on their devices wirelessly.

MSI Sky Talk is an all-in-one solution for such users. Its Bluetooth headset and USB dongle let you use your Bluetooth phone the way it should be used—*sans* wires. The headset has a main button and volume controls. There are three options to charge the internal rechargeable battery—the power adaptor, the USB cable, and the car adaptor.

A blinking LED on the front indicates various status modes—‘standby’, ‘pairing’, ‘charging’, ‘battery low’, and so on. Once paired, you can accept and reject calls, redial the last dialled number, and even voice-dial (if your phone supports it)—all from the headset itself.

We paired the headset with a few phones and found the device rather decent in terms of voice clarity, range, and battery life. The USB dongle confirms to Bluetooth v1.1. You just need to plug it into a PC or notebook, install the drivers, and voilà—you’re ready to live the wire-free life!

Company **Micro-Star International**

Price **Rs 4,500**

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Rating



Wipro LittleGenius Ultra Slim WLGCPU SL

The LittleGenius WLGCPU SL is part of Wipro’s Ultra Slim range of notebook PCs—it weighs 1.35 kg and is 27 mm thick. Based on the Centrino Mobile technology, it is powered by an Intel Pentium M 1600 MHz processor with 256 MB of DDR RAM. It has a 12.1-inch monitor with a resolution of 1024 x 768. There’s an external combo drive, which, quite unusually, is a top loading drive.

Connectivity options for the WLGCPU SL include three USB 2.0 ports and a high-speed FireWire port.

There’s a slot for PCMCIA Type II cards.

There’s no Bluetooth or infrared, but there is Wi-Fi b+g and a 10/100 LAN with a standard 56 Kbps modem. Its memory card reader supports SD, MS and MMC cards.

In the ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004 test, it scored 16.4—an ordinary score for a laptop. In the battery life test, it lasted an hour and 34 minutes. Although bundled with Windows XP Professional SP2, eTrust Anti-Virus, Nero Burning ROM and Unistal Data Recovery software, the Rs 84,990 price tag will make buyers think twice.

Company **Wipro Limited**

Price **Rs 84,990**

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Rating



Philips PET710 Portable DVD Player

Calling All Movie Buffs!

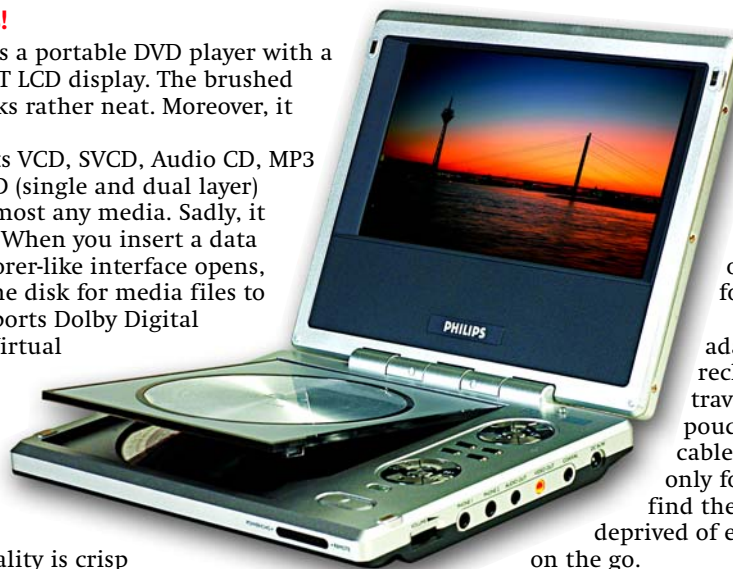
The Philips PET710 is a portable DVD player with a seven-inch wide TFT LCD display. The brushed aluminium finish looks rather neat. Moreover, it weighs just 0.8 kg.

The player supports VCD, SVCD, Audio CD, MP3 CD, Photo CD and DVD (single and dual layer) formats burned on almost any media. Sadly, it doesn’t support DivX. When you insert a data disk, a Windows Explorer-like interface opens, and you can browse the disk for media files to play. Moreover, it supports Dolby Digital audio in addition to Virtual Surround sound.

A full-function remote control is also provided; however, the buttons are a bit too stiff and hard on the fingers.

The LCD image quality is crisp and bright. One thing we noticed is that it is fairly viewable even when used outdoors. The speakers, though, sounded tinny and produced all treble and no bass!

The unit functions as a regular DVD player when connected to a TV with the TV-out and audio-out using the supplied cables. There is even a digital coaxial audio-out, and dual headphone jacks so you can connect two headphones simultaneously.



This DVD player can be powered using the bundled power adaptor or a rechargeable Li-ion battery. When we tested it, the battery lasted three and a half hours, which surpassed the battery life claimed by the manufacturer by a good one hour. More than enough for any movie out there!

The PET710 comes with a car adaptor in case you wish to recharge and view it while travelling. It comes with a leather pouch along with all the necessary cables. Retailing at Rs 19,990, it is only for serious movie buffs who find themselves crippled when deprived of entertainment even when on the go.

Company **Philips Electronics India Limited**

Price **Rs 19,990**

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Rating

